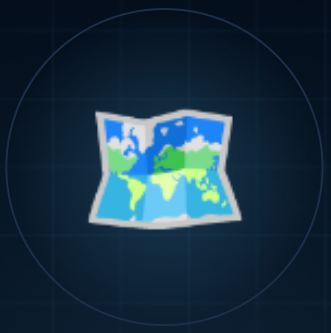


The Cartographers

RECON, OSINT & ATTACK-SURFACE MAPPING TOOLS

38	303.9k	25	20
CURATED TOOLS	COMBINED STARS	ON GITHUB	ACTIVE IN 2026

2026 EDITION · DEEP-RESEARCH DOSSIER

Live GitHub census pulled 2026-10-17 · part of 438 curated free tools across 14 realms

CC0 · 2026-10-17

38	25	303.9k	20	5.1k	2010
CURATED TOOLS	ON GITHUB	COMBINED STARS	PUSHED 2026	MEDIAN STARS	OLDEST ENTRY

REALM BRIEF

Map the terrain before you move — subdomain, content and OSINT discovery for bug bounty and asset management.

The mapping layer of offensive work — subdomain enumeration, certificate transparency, DNS archaeology and attack-surface diffing. The projectdiscovery suite lives here, alongside the classic recon one-liners every bounty hunter memorizes.

FIELD INTELLIGENCE · AI-ASSISTED

The Cartographers realm of recon, OSINT, and attack-surface mapping includes 38 free tools, 33 hosted on GitHub, with a combined 303,940 total stars and 27 code pushes in 2026. Its maturity profile is defined by long-standing, high-impact tools: theHarvester (launched 2011, 18.0k stars) and ffuf (2018, 16.9k stars) anchor the ecosystem, while newer tools like katana (2021, 17.7k stars) show sustained relevance. The star distribution reveals concentrated demand for core, battle-tested recon utilities rather than niche tools, with top five tools holding 58% of total stars. A notable trend is the consolidation of OSINT identity mapping efforts around Sherlock (94.3k stars, the realm's most starred tool), which has become a de facto standard for username enumeration across platforms.

Synthesized by seed-2-0-mini over the live census: stars, first-release years, push activity and project claims pulled from the GitHub API on 2026-10-17. Human-curated realm, AI-summarized numbers.

LICENSE MIX · GITHUB-HOSTED ENTRIES



MIT	12
GPL family	5
Other / none	3
BSD	3
AGPL	1
Apache-2.0	1

MATURITY PROFILE

Oldest tracked entry first appeared on GitHub in **2010**; the youngest joined in **2026**. 20 of 25 GitHub-hosted tools shipped code in 2026 — the rest are stable classics or web services, not abandoned picks.

Median project age signals a battle-tested realm; recent arrivals mark where the community is investing next.

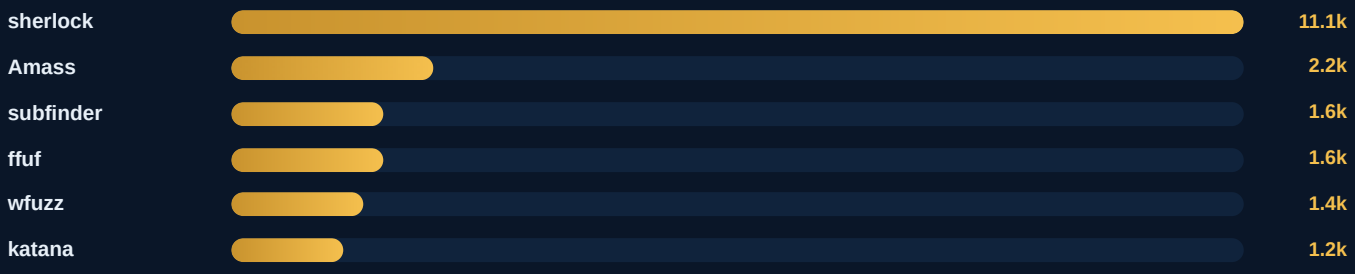
SNAPSHOT

- Active in the last 30 days: 14 of 33 tracked GitHub repos (42%)
- Archived upstream (kept — still reference-quality): [JA3](https://github.com/salesforce/ja3), [HASSH](https://github.com/salesforce/hassh)
- Quiet classics (no push in 2+ years, still the standard): assetfinder, ike-scan
- Youngest entries: dnsrecon (2010), theHarvester (2011), ike-scan (2013)

TOP TOOLS BY GITHUB STARS



MOST FORKED — REAL-WORLD REUSE SIGNAL



THE NEWCOMERS — NEWEST ARRIVALS

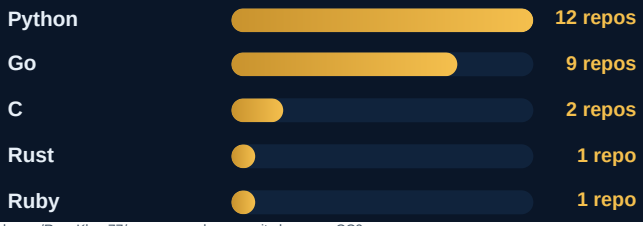
AtDork	2026
Awesome Censys Queries	2022
waymore	2022
bbot	2022
katana	2021
dnsx	2020

QUIET CLASSICS — STILL THE STANDARD

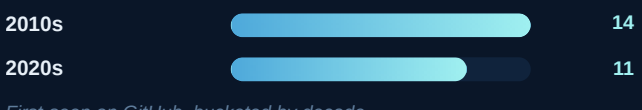
assetfinder, ike-scan

Tools with no recent push that remain the community's default reference for their job.

LANGUAGE MIX — GITHUB-HOSTED ENTRIES



CREATION ERAS — WHEN THIS REALM WAS BUILT



First-seen on GitHub, bucketed by decade.

HOW TO READ A DOSSIER

Each heavyweight gets a full dossier: live GitHub census (stars, forks, first-release year, last push, license, language), the project's own claim, our curator's note, a signal check, and its star weight against the realm's #1. Numbers are pulled straight from the GitHub API on 2026-10-17 — no self-reported marketing figures, only what the platforms show.

THE CENSUS METRICS — WHAT EACH NUMBER MEANS

★ GitHub stars
Community trust signal — how many developers bookmarked the repo.

Forks · reuse
Real-world deployment signal — forks mean people build on it.

First developed
Year the repo first appeared on GitHub — the project's true age.

Last push
Most recent code push — the project's heartbeat.

License
What you may legally do with it. MIT/Apache = permissive.

2026 momentum
Shipped code during 2026 — active development, not abandonware.

THE ROSTER — PROFILED THIS EDITION

RANK 01
sherlock
94.3k ★ · since 2018

RANK 02
katana
17.7k ★ · since 2021

RANK 03
ffuf
16.9k ★ · since 2018

RANK 04
Amass
15.4k ★ · since 2018

RANK 05
GHunt
— ★ · since 2020

RANK 06
theHarvester
— ★ · since 2011

METHODOLOGY & PROVENANCE

Census pulled via the GitHub REST API on 2026-10-17; realm curation and curator's notes by the Awesome Cyber Security Heaven maintainers; field-intelligence summaries synthesized by seed-2-0-mini from the same census. Everything reproducible — every figure traces back to a public API response. Released under CC0.

01 SHERLOCK

github.com/sherlock-project/sherlock

● ACTIVE 2026

★ 94.3k	11.1k	2018	2026-10	MIT	Python
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

8	351	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (SHERLOCK · 94.3K)

REUSE SIGNAL

11.8% fork-to-star ratio — healthy reuse.

ISSUE HEALTH

351 open — actively triaged.

LONGEVITY

8 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“Hunt down social media accounts by username across social networks”

● CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Hunt down social media accounts by username across social networks

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Cartographers · realm rank #1 by adoption

02 Katana

github.com/projectdiscovery/katana

● ACTIVE 2026

★ 17.7k	1.2k	2021	2026-10	MIT	Go
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

5	26	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (SHERLOCK · 94.3K)

REUSE SIGNAL
6.9% fork-to-star ratio — reference-grade adoption.

ISSUE HEALTH
26 open — lean queue.

LONGEVITY
5 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● **THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT**

“A next-generation crawling and spidering framework.”

● **CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE**

A next-generation crawling and spidering framework.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Cartographers · realm rank #2 by adoption

03 ffuf

github.com/ffuf/ffuf

● ACTIVE 2026

★ 16.9k	1.6k	2018	2026-09	MIT	Go
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

8	238	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (SHERLOCK · 94.3K)

REUSE SIGNAL

9.6% fork-to-star ratio — healthy reuse.

ISSUE HEALTH

238 open — actively triaged.

LONGEVITY

8 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“Fast web fuzzer written in Go”

● CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Fast web fuzzer written in Go

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Cartographers · realm rank #3 by adoption

04 Amass

github.com/owasp-amass/amass

● ACTIVE 2026

★ 15.4k	2.2k	2018	2026-07	Custom	Go
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

8	245	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (SHERLOCK · 94.3K)

REUSE SIGNAL

14.3% fork-to-star ratio — healthy reuse.

ISSUE HEALTH

245 open — actively triaged.

LONGEVITY

8 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● **THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT**

“In-depth attack surface mapping and asset discovery”

● **CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE**

In-depth attack surface mapping and asset discovery

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Cartographers · realm rank #4 by adoption

05 GHunt

github.com/mxrch/GHunt

● ACTIVE 2026

★ —	—	2020	2026-04	—	—
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

6	—	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (SHERLOCK · 94.3K)

REUSE SIGNAL

— fork-to-star ratio — reference-grade adoption.

ISSUE HEALTH

—.

LONGEVITY

6 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“🕵️ Offensive Google framework.”

● CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

🕵️ Offensive Google framework.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Cartographers · realm rank #5 by adoption

06 theHarvester

github.com/laramies/theHarvester

● ACTIVE 2026

★ —	—	2011	2026-10	—	—
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

15	—	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (SHERLOCK · 94.3K)

REUSE SIGNAL

— fork-to-star ratio — reference-grade adoption.

ISSUE HEALTH

—.

LONGEVITY

15 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“E-mails, subdomains and names Harvester - OSINT”

● CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

E-mails, subdomains and names Harvester - OSINT

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Cartographers · realm rank #6 by adoption

The complete curated inventory for this realm — flagship picks marked ★. Stars and activity chips reflect the 2026-10-17 census.

sherlock ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 94.2k | since 2018 | active 2026

hunt one username across 400+ social networks; people-OSINT in seconds.

github.com/sherlock-project/sherlock

GHunt ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 19.7k | since 2020 | AGPL-3.0

investigate a Google account's public footprint (photos, reviews, services) from an email — for authorized OSINT; respect ToS.

github.com/mxrch/GHunt

theHarvester ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 18.0k | since 2011 | GPL-2.0

emails, subdomains, hosts and names from public sources — the OSINT starter kit.

github.com/laramies/theHarvester

katana ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 17.7k | since 2021 | active 2026

next-generation crawler with headless-browser support for JavaScript-heavy applications.

github.com/projectdiscovery/katana

ffuf ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 16.9k | since 2018 | active 2026

the fast web fuzzer everyone uses for content, parameter and vhost discovery.

github.com/ffuf/ffuf

Amass ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 15.4k | since 2018 | active 2026

deep attack-surface mapping: DNS enumeration, scraping, archives, APIs and permutations in one OWASP project.

github.com/owasp-amass/amass

subfinder

★ 14.6k | since 2018 | active 2026

fast, passive subdomain discovery from dozens of sources; the standard first command of any engagement.

github.com/projectdiscovery/subfinder

gobuster

★ 14.2k | since 2014

the classic directory/DNS/vhost buster in Go; the tool feroxbuster and ffuf grew from.

github.com/OJ/gobuster

bbot

★ 10.7k | since 2022 | AGPL-3.0 | active 2026

recursive, modular OSINT/scanning framework — spider the whole attack surface with one command.

github.com/blacklanternsecurity/bbot

httpx

★ 10.5k | since 2020 | active 2026

the HTTP prober: filter thousands of hosts by status, title, tech, CDN and TLS in a single pass.

github.com/projectdiscovery/httpx

feroxbuster

★ 8.1k | since 2020 | active 2026

fast recursive content discovery in Rust with great heuristics and recursion handling.

github.com/epi052/feroxbuster

wfuzz

★ 6.6k | since 2014 | GPL-2.0 | active 2026

the web fuzzer that replaces any part of a request with a payload — parameters, headers, paths, verbs.

github.com/xmendez/wfuzz

naabu

★ 6.3k | since 2020 | active 2026

fast, SYN-based port scanner built to be pipelined, not watched.

github.com/projectdiscovery/naabu

recon-ng

★ 6.0k | since 2019 | GPL-3.0 | active 2026

the other recon framework: fully modular, database-backed web recon with a Metasploit-style console.

github.com/lanmaster53/recon-ng

EyeWitness

★ 5.9k | since 2014 | GPL-3.0

screenshots, headers and key info from web servers during authorized recon passes.

github.com/RedSiege/EyeWitness

dnstwist

★ 5.8k | since 2015

detect typosquat, homograph and permutation lookalikes of your domain — a must for phishing defense and brand monitoring.

github.com/elceef/dnstwist

gau

★ 5.1k · since 2020 · active 2026

fetch URLs indexed by AlienVault OTX, the Wayback Machine and Common Crawl.

github.com/lc/gau

assetfinder

★ 3.7k · since 2019

passive subdomain discovery that polls a dozen public sources and prints a clean list — no keys needed; quiet upstream, still the classic.

github.com/tomnomnom/assetfinder

massdns

★ 3.7k · since 2016 · GPL-3.0 · active 2026

high-performance DNS stub resolver for bulk subdomain brute-forcing at scale.

github.com/blechschmidt/massdns

ParamSpider

★ 3.2k · since 2020

mines archived URLs and parameters from the Wayback Machine to seed injection testing.

github.com/devanshbatham/ParamSpider

JA3

★ 3.1k · since 2017 · BSD-3-Clause

the TLS client fingerprint standard: a 12-byte hash that identifies client software across the wire.

github.com/salesforce/ja3

dnsrecon

★ 3.1k · since 2010 · GPL-2.0 · active 2026

DNS enumeration workhorse: records, zone transfers, reverse lookups and subdomain brute-forcing.

github.com/darkoperator/dnsrecon

dnsx

★ 2.9k · since 2020 · active 2026

multi-purpose DNS toolkit: reverse lookups, wildcard detection, response filtering.

github.com/projectdiscovery/dnsx

waymore

★ 2.8k · since 2022 · active 2026

pull way more from the Wayback Machine: full responses, not just URLs.

github.com/xnl-h4ck3r/waymore

JARM

★ 1.3k · since 2020 · BSD-3-Clause · active 2026

active TLS server fingerprint: identifies servers behind CDNs from their handshake behavior.

github.com/salesforce/jarm

VHostScan

★ 1.3k · since 2017 · GPL-3.0

enumerates virtual hosts on a shared IP — discover the neighbors your target lives with.

github.com/codingo/VHostScan

Awesome Censys Queries

★ 1.3k · since 2022 · CC-BY-4.0, curated list · active 2026

a curated corpus of Censys search queries for internet-wide recon.

github.com/thehappydinoa/awesome-censys-queries

Recog

★ 795 · since 2013 · BSD-3-Clause · active 2026

the fingerprint database behind Metasploit and Nexpose: service banners mapped to OS and product families.

github.com/rapid7/recog

HASSH

★ 554 · since 2018 · BSD-3-Clause

SSH key-exchange fingerprinting: identify client/server software from the KEX packet alone.

github.com/salesforce/hassh

ike-scan

★ 423 · since 2013 · GPL-2.0

IKE/IPsec security auditing: fingerprint VPN gateways and enumerate transform proposals.

github.com/royhills/ike-scan

DorkEye

★ 151 · since 2025 · MIT

OSINT dork pipeline: email, subdomain and people discovery through structured query automation.

github.com/xPloits3c/DorkEye

AtDork

★ 43 · since 2026 · MIT · active 2026

multi-engine Google-dork scraper with categorized GHDB output for authorized reconnaissance.

github.com/amnottdevv/atdork

DorkCraft

★ 9 · since 2026 · MIT

rule-based dork generator: translates intent into search queries deterministically, zero AI, zero outbound calls.

Maltego CE

free tier

the standard OSINT graphing tool for entity-relationship investigation; free community edition.

WiGLE

free service

the wireless network mapping archive; queries by BSSID/SSID across millions of observed networks.

wigle.net

DNSdumpster

free service

visual DNS reconnaissance: subdomains, MX, and infrastructure maps from public records.

dnsdumpster.com

CeWL

GPL-3.0

custom wordlist generation by spidering target sites — the content-aware dictionary for authorized assessments.

digi.ninja/projects/cewl.php

Merklemap

free service

subdomain discovery through certificate-transparency logs; billions of entries, searchable.

merklemap.com



End of inventory — 38 curated entries in The Cartographers

Census 2026-10-17 · every entry human-curated · stars and activity verified against the live GitHub API.
Thirteen more realm dossiers — Armory, Bastion, Watchtower and friends — live in the same repository.

Awesome Cyber Security Heaven

438 FREE TOOLS · 14 REALMS · ONE CURATED HEAVEN

This dossier covered **The Cartographers**.

Thirteen more realm dossiers wait in the same repository — Armory, Bastion, Watchtower, Cartographers, Shadow Bureau, Vault, Foundry, Sentinel Ops, Oracle's Domain, AI Forge, Free Bazaar, Academy, Proving Grounds and Workshop.

438	14	CC0
CURATED TOOLS	REALM DOSSIERS	LICENSE

github.com/RanaKhan77/awesome-cyber-security-heaven

Free forever · community-curated · 2026-10-17 census